

This was just the start. By August 1968, Roberts and DARPA funded community refined the overall structure and specifications for ARPANET. This led to a release of a 'Request For Quotation' by DARPA to manufacture packet switches called Interface Message Processors, which, was fulfilled by a firm called BBN. Bob Kahn from BBN worked on the IMP's while Roberts worked on and optimised the network topology and economics. At the same time, Kleinrock's team at UCLA prepared a network measurement system.

Kleinrock's Network Measurement Center at the University of California at Los Angeles (UCLA) was selected to be the first node on the ARPANET. All this finally came together in September 1969 when BBN installed the first IMP at UCLA and the first host computer was connected.

Stanford Research Institute was selected as the second node and when SRI was connected to the ARPANET, the first host-to-host message was sent from Kleinrock's laboratory to SRI. Two more nodes were added at UC Santa Barbara and University of Utah and at the end of 1969 four host computers were connected into the initial ARPANET, and the fledgling Internet came into existence.

Bob Kahn organised a large and successful demonstration of the ARPANET in October 1972 at the International Computer Communication Conference (ICCC) which was also the first time that this completely new networking technology was demonstrated in front of the general public. In the same year, the electronic mail or e-mail, as we know it, was introduced. Ray Tomlinson from BBN wrote a very basic e-mail 'read and send' software that was later developed further by Roberts. The development was driven by the need of ARPANET developers to coordinate amongst themselves but by the next decade, e-mail became the largest network application to have ever hit the internet.